SAMPLE

Clothing and Appearance: The Garment of Dignity

Clothing and Appearance in the Quran

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Free sample: Introduction & Chapter 1
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Introduction

The Quran addresses clothing and appearance not as a matter of fashion but as a matter of dignity, modesty, and spiritual identity. The clothing that the believer wears is the outward expression of the inward state, and the Quranic guidance for clothing is the guidance for the visible self. The Quran says: "O children of Adam, We have bestowed upon you clothing to conceal your private parts and as adornment. But the clothing of righteousness - that is best. That is from the signs of Allah that perhaps they may remember" (7:26). The verse establishes two functions of clothing: concealment and adornment, and then points to a higher function: righteousness. This book examines the Quranic guidance for clothing and appearance, exploring the key verses, the prophetic tradition, and the lessons that emerge from the Quranic framework for the visible self. The book covers the three levels of clothing - functional, aesthetic, and spiritual - and the specific guidance for men and women. It also addresses the balance between adornment and humility, the social function of Islamic dress, and the eternal perspective on clothing. The book is part of the Life in the Quran sub-series of the NurOne master series by Aira Aurora. The approach is through the Quranic text, supplemented by authentic prophetic tradition, and avoids speculation beyond what the sources provide. The goal is to present the Quranic guidance for clothing and appearance with clarity, fidelity, and depth, so that the reader can approach the visible self with the consciousness of Allah that the Quranic framework prescribes, and the consciousness is the foundation of the dignity that the clothing expresses and the modesty that the clothing protects.

Chapter 1: The Quranic Principle of Clothing

The Quran establishes the principle of clothing in the verse addressed to the children of Adam: "O children of Adam, We have bestowed upon you clothing to conceal your private parts and as adornment. But the clothing of righteousness - that is best" (7:26). The verse establishes three levels of clothing: the functional (concealment), the aesthetic (adornment), and the spiritual (righteousness). The functional level is the basic requirement - clothing covers what must be covered. The aesthetic level is the enhancement - clothing is also a form of beauty. The spiritual level is the highest - the clothing of righteousness, which is the internal quality that the external clothing reflects.

The Quran connects clothing to the origin of humanity. After Adam and Hawwa ate from the tree, their private parts became exposed, and they began to cover themselves with leaves: "So they both ate of it, and their private parts became apparent to them, and they began to fasten over themselves from the leaves of Paradise" (20:121). The instinct to cover is the first response to the loss of innocence, and the instinct is the origin of clothing. The clothing that Adam and Hawwa made for themselves was inadequate, and Allah provided them with proper clothing: "O children of Adam, We have bestowed upon you clothing" (7:26).

The Quran says: "O children of Adam, let not Satan tempt you as he removed your parents from Paradise, stripping them of their clothing to show them their private parts" (7:27). The verse connects nakedness to the temptation of Satan. The prohibition of nakedness is the protection against the temptation, and the protection is the expression of the Quranic principle that the human being's dignity is preserved through the covering that Allah has prescribed.